

cally give over some of that time to get a business education, or in other ways to improve your earning status. But do not let a day go by without taking some time for yourself—some time you spend in pure pleasure, as you see it. This is part of being yourself. It helps you always to keep in touch with yourself, so to speak. With increasing success, increase your hours of pure enjoyment; do not allow those hours to be eaten away by business or by anything else.

Some time ago a close friend came to visit me. He found me dressed in my shorts, lying on the grass in the back yard and playing ball with my dogs.

"What a picture," he exclaimed. "I guess you wouldn't want your public to see you as you are now."

"I wouldn't mind it a bit," I replied. "I'd like people to know I practice what I preach. Here I am, doing precisely what I wish to do at this moment. Can anyone be better off than in doing what he wishes to do?"

If any man needed simple freedom, my friend did. He spent a good deal more than eight hours a day as the operating executive of a large financial house, and often worked far into the night. With millions of dollars, he had no peace of mind and his health had begun to suffer.

He telephoned me the next day. "Guess what I've been doing for the past hour!"

"I can't imagine, but I'd certainly like to know."

He laughed gaily. "Playing with my dog, and it's wonderful!" A moment of silence; then he said: "Believe me, I'm going to play and *live* hereafter!"

I set down the key thoughts of this chapter many years ago. Woodrow Wilson read what I had written and said: "It inspired thoughts which were not of this world."

On another occasion I received President Wilson just as I had received my old friend, in my shorts while romping with my dogs. He was grateful. That harassed man shared, if only for a few minutes, the blessedness of having time to be one's relaxed self.

When you see yourself as your own master and carry the vision into action, you use the Supreme Secret.

CHECKING ON CHAPTER 9:

The basic drives that make a man

The "nuts and bolts" of earning money are important, but